

2.1 www.myspace.com

The big daddy in this genre, no other site has received as much publicity as MySpace has. It is like the Oracle of data storage, or the Cisco of network devices. It has both ardent fans as well as vitriolic critics. It was originally started by Tom Andersen and



Chris DeWolfe in November 2003 (though there is some dispute) and acquired by Rupert Murdoch's News Corporation in July 2005 for US \$580 million.

As a social networking site MySpace is a one-stop shop. You can add pictures, write blogs, make friends, upload music and video, organise offline events with your online buddies and do gazillions of other things (shave Britney and get a ringtone). But MySpace's USP is that unlike most other sites which deal in social networking, it offers you complete leeway to modify and customise your profile page. You get to decide which colours and fonts to keep, what apps to embed and what should be your profile's look and feel. These effects are achieved by copy pasting simple HTML and CSS code. The MySpace Profile Editor can be used to good effect.

Once you have tweaked your profile to your heart's content, get cracking. Whenever you get yourself a new account, Tom Andersen (the founder) gets added to your friend list by default. Since he remains a friend in a majority of the lists, this is a place to start hunting for friends in case you don't know anybody at MySpace. Of course you can idly browse through profiles from the main page and latch on to somebody interesting. And if you have friends already then it's a walk in the park. As you start developing your contacts and making new friends you will find